Igor B. Martins

Postdoctoral Researcher at Linköping University, also affiliated with Lund University

igor.martins@liu.se | ibmartins.com Malmö, Sweden

Academic Experience

2020– **Postdoctoral Researcher**

Linköping University Sweden 2026–
Lund University Sweden 2023–2026
University of Cambridge United Kingdom 2022–2023
Lund University Sweden 2020–2022

2017–2018 **Visiting Researcher**

Stellenbosch University South Africa

Education

2016–2020 **Ph.D., Economic History**

Lund University Sweden

2014–2016 **M.Sc., Economic History**

Lund University Sweden

2008–2011 **B.Sc., Economics**

Fundação Getulio Vargas Brazil

Published works

- **Martins, I.** (forthcoming). Living Standards in Ghana, 1955–2005, in G. Austin, A. Britwum, L. Doumbia, A. Eckert, & N.Y. Sapong (eds), *Labour and Work in Ghana Since Independence*, London: Bloomsbury Academic.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (forthcoming). Från arbetskraft till kapital: Slaveriets ekonomiska logik i globalt perspektiv, *Statsvetenskaplig tidskrift*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Slavery after the 1807 import ban in the Cape Colony, *European Review of Economic History*, heag012.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2026). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Journal of Global History*, vol. 21, no. 1, pp.22–40.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Is the Business of Conquest the Conquest of Business?, *The Case Centre*, 225-0045-1.
- Cilliers, J., Mariotti, M., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Fertility Responses to Short-Term Economic Stress: Price volatility and wealth shocks in a pre-transitional settler colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101620.

- Axelsson, T., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Resilience to Shrinking as a Catch-up Strategy: A comparison of Brazil and Indonesia, 1964–2019, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, vol. 59, no. 3, pp.491–516.
- Smythe, A., **Martins, I.**, & Andersson, M. (2024). Inequality, Poverty, and Resilience to Economic Shrinking, *International Journal of Development Issues*, vol. 23, no. 1, pp.40–81.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). An Age of Disentangled Research?, *Issues in Science and Technology*, vol. 40, no. 1, pp.38–43.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2023). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101506.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). *Shifting Patterns in International Research Cooperation*, Stockholm: STINT.
- **Martins, I.** (2020). Collateral Effect: Slavery and wealth in the Cape Colony, PhD thesis, Department of Economic History, Lund University.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2019). What Caused Poverty Reduction in Brazil During the 2000s: Sectoral growth or public expenditures, *OASIS. Observatorio de Análisis de los Sistemas Internacionales*, no. 31, pp.185–213.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2018). Poverty and Democracy: The Brazilian experience, in D. Rauhut & N. Hatti (eds), *Poverty, Politics and the Poverty of Politics*, New Delhi: B.R. Publishing Corporation, pp.193–210.

Works under review

- **Martins, I.** (2026). The Case for Artisanal Doctoral Supervision, *Studies in Higher Education*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Retrieval-Restricted Reasoning: Supporting Scholarly Synthesis with Language Models, *Historical Methods: A Journal of Quantitative and Interdisciplinary History*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.**, Grab, S., & Green, E. (2026). Weather as a vector of inequality, *Nature Communications*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Slave Emancipation and Agricultural Output in the Cape Colony, *Cliometrica*. Submitted.
- Makuei, J., & **Martins, I.** (2026). Democracy and Rural Inequality in Kenya, 1997–2010, *African Affairs*. Submitted.

Work in progress

- **Martins, I.** Income Inequality in Late Colonial Angola, 1940–1970.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Wealth and Adult Mortality in a Pre-Industrial Settler Society: Evidence from Cape Probate Inventories.
- **Martins, I.**, Schoots, J., & Green, E. Held by the Elite: Monopoly Rights and Family Fortunes at the Cape of Good Hope, 1680–1794.
- Smythe, A., & **Martins, I.** Catch-up and Resilience to Shrinking, 1890–2019.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Forebearers: The forgotten women of the Cape Colony.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. What Are Institutions Made Of? A social contract approach.

- **Martins, I.**, Aboagye, P., & Austin, G. The Ghanaian Divergence: Prices, incomes and living standards after independence.

External funding

2027–2029 **Handelsbanken Research Foundations**
Flying Blind: Tsetse Ecology, Colonial Response and Long-Run Health in Southeast Africa (P26-0357) Project researcher. Engaged at 30% for three years.
SEK 1,500,000 (≈ EUR 138,500 / USD 163,000)

2024–2027 **Vetenskapsrådet**
Causes and Consequences of Long-Term Inequality: Africa's Levels and Trends (2023-00809_VR) Project researcher. Engaged at 20% for two years.
SEK 6,737,000 (≈ EUR 623,623 / USD 735,688)

2022–2026 **Handelsbanken Research Foundations**
Resilience to Economic Shrinking: The Role of Autonomous Financial Systems (P21-0044) Project researcher. Engaged at approx. 30% for two years.
SEK 1,725,000 (≈ EUR 150,000 / USD 164,000)

2022–2025 **Arts and Humanities Research Council (UK)**
Where have all the Workers Gone? Labour and Work in Ghana, 1951–2010 (AH/W010852/1) Postdoctoral Research Associate. Engaged at 100% for one year.
SEK 3,332,000 (≈ EUR 308,438 / GBP 268,859)

2021–2026 **Riksbankens Jubileumsfond**
The establishment, growth and legacy of a settler colony: Quantitative panel studies of the political economy of the Cape Colony (M20-0041) Project researcher. Engaged at 40% for four years (2021–2024) and 20% for two years (2025–2026).
SEK 29,000,000 (≈ EUR 2,520,000 / USD 2,760,000)

2017–2018 **Erasmus Mundus Action 2 Programme (INSPIRE)**
Scholarship Stellenbosch University, South Africa
Supported research training on the economic history of the Cape Colony.
SEK 157,000

Teaching experience

2025– **Development in a Historical Perspective - Economic, Social and Political Transformation**
Lund University Course convener

2023–2026 **Growth, Stagnation, and Inequality in Africa**
Lund University Course convener

2019– **Colonialism and Economic Change in Africa, Asia and Latin America**
Lund University Lecturer

2019–2026 **The Art of Writing and Reporting**
Lund University Course convener

2019–2026 **Field Work/Internship and Research Overview**
Lund University Course convener

Pedagogical qualifications

2025 **Course design in higher education**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2024 **Doctoral supervision**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2022 **Teaching and learning in higher education II**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2021 **Teaching and learning in higher education I**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2020 **How to teach with cases**
Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

2019 **How to write cases**
Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

Supervision

2023–2026 **Doctoral**
Benjamin Chatterton, PhD in Economic History Lund University
Co-supervisor
Expected completion November 2026

2021– **Master's**
14 theses in Economic History Lund University

2019– **Bachelor's**
7 theses in Economic History Lund University

Awards

2020 **Teacher of the Year**
Lund University School of Economics and Management

Media Outreach

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Assessing students' academic writing when AI can produce a first draft, *Times Higher Education*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Using Portuguese Sources to Build an Angolan Social Table, *African Long-Term Inequality Trends (AFLIT)*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Why Slavery Persisted after Britain Banned the Trade, *European Historical Economics Society*.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2026). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Devo, não nego, pago com o meu escravo - Como pessoas escravizadas viravam garantia de crédito, *The Conversation Brasil*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). What Is Economic History?, *Tell Me About* [podcast].
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Students Learn Best When They're Not Handed a Map: 4 steps to structure discomfort in your case classroom, *Inspiring Minds*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). The Pressure to Quantify Research Is Erasing Conceptual Depth, *LSE Impact Blog*.
- Kim, H., Schwaag Serger, S., Mobrand, E., & **Martins, I.** (2024). International Science Is Having a Messy Breakup, *Research Professional News*.
- **Martins, I.** (2023). Does a Negative Wealth Shock Affect Your Health? Evidence from an episode of 'Expropriation with Partial Compensation' in nineteenth-century South Africa, *Our Long Walk: Reflections on South Africa, from an Economic History Perspective*.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2023). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.

Editorial and Review Experience

Ongoing **Editor**
Frontiers in African Economic History
Blog of the African Economic History Network. Weekly curation of Africa-related articles across eight journals, commissioning and editing of blog essays, and coordination of the editorial workflow.

2026– **Peer-reviewer**
Studies in Higher Education

2025 **Peer-reviewer**
International Journal of Development Issues

2025 **Peer-reviewer**
Asia-Pacific Economic History Review

2024 **Peer-reviewer**
Studies in Comparative International Development

2023 **Peer-reviewer**
Technological Forecasting and Social Change

Service

2026– **International Economic History Association**
Secretariat
Supports the Secretary General with the administration of the association and the preparation of the World Economic History Congress, and keeps the record of Executive Committee meetings.

2025–2026 **United Nations Development Programme**
Consultant
Commissioned by the UNDP's Strategy, Policy and Capacities for Economic Management (SPACE) Unit of South Sudan as a consultant to the country's first Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) report.

2023– **Swedish Economic History Association**
Auditor
The SEHA promotes the spread of knowledge about economic and social history, as well as historical and geographical research. The association organises lectures and conferences.

2023–2025 **World Economic History Congress 2025**
Lund, Sweden
Conference Manager
Co-organised the 19th WEHC, a major international conference in economic history with more than 1,100 participants. Contributed to programme coordination, hybrid participation logistics, volunteer management, statistical reporting, and post-conference analysis. Oversaw technical workflows, communication, and strategic structuring of the scientific and cultural programme.

2023–2024 **The Swedish Foundation for International Cooperation in Research and Higher Education (STINT)**
Consultant
STINT supports internationalisation in Swedish higher education by funding initiatives led by researchers, educators, and academic leaders.

2022–2023 **Clare Hall** Affiliated Postdoctoral Member
Clare Hall is a constituent college of the University of Cambridge established to serve as an Institute of Advanced Studies.

2021–2023 **Swedish Economic History Association**
Treasurer

2017– **Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past**
Stellenbosch University
Visiting Researcher
The Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past is dedicated to the quantitative study of African economic and social history.

Professional memberships

Economic History Association, Economic History Society, Social Science History Association, African Economic History Network, Swedish Economic History Association

Recent conferences, workshops and seminars

03/2027 **Trelleborgs Biblioteket**
Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker** (scheduled)
What is the difference between colonialism and globalisation?

10/2026 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
University of Gothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**
Weather as a vector of inequality

02/2026 **Trelleborgs Biblioteket**
Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker**
How did colonial institutions shape African democracy and development?

07/2025 **World Economic History Congress**
Lund, Sweden **Organiser & Panellist**
The geography of development in Portuguese Africa: Lessons from Angola

12/2024 **African Studies Association**
Chicago, USA **Panellist**
Market Integration and the Development of Capitalism in Ghana, 1987–2005

12/2023 **Utbildningsdepartementet**
Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**
Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023 **Seminarium om förändrade mönster för internationella forskningssamarbeten**
Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**
Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Lund, Sweden **Organizer & Panellist**
Catch-up and Resilience to Shrinking, 1890–2019

03/2023 **African Economic History Seminar**
Cambridge, United Kingdom **Panellist**
Raising capital to raise crops: Slave emancipation and agricultural output in the Cape Colony

Selected earlier conferences (2017–2022)

10/2022 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
Tenerife, Spain **Panellist**

07/2022 **World Economic History Congress**
Paris, France **Panellist**

10/2021 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Gothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**

10/2019 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Uppsala, Sweden **Panellist**

01/2019 **Allied Social Sciences Association**
Atlanta, USA **Panellist**

10/2018 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
Bologna, Italy **Panellist**

07/2018 **World Economic History Congress**
Boston, USA **Panellist**

04/2018 **European Social Science History Conference**
Belfast, UK **Panellist**

10/2017 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
Stellenbosch, South Africa **Panellist**

Administrative references

Prof. Mats Olsson
Lund University, Sweden
mats.olsson@ekh.lu.se

Prof. Leigh Gardner
London School of Economics, UK
l.a.gardner@lse.ac.uk

Academic references

Prof. Erik Green
Lund University, Sweden
erik.green@ekh.lu.se

Prof. Gareth Austin
University of Cambridge, UK
gma31@cam.ac.uk

Prof. Anne McCants
MIT, USA
amccants@mit.edu

Prof. Jeanne Cilliers
Linköping University, Sweden
jeanne.cilliers@liu.se

Teaching references

Dr. Tobias Axelsson
Lund University, Sweden
tobias.axelsson@ekh.lu.se

Assoc. Prof. Tobias Karlsson
Lund University, Sweden
tobias.karlsson@ekh.lu.se